

Third-party payment continuity

Correspondence with the Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services — August 17 to September 11, 2026

Seven questions were put to the Minister in writing on August 17, 2026, about what happened to third-party rent payments and Financial Administrator arrangements when files moved from AISH to ADAP. An automated acknowledgement arrived the same minute. A substantive response arrived twenty-five days later and answered one of the seven questions.

The full exchange is reproduced below, in order and without alteration.

1. Letter to the Minister

From: Chantal Trepanier, The Alberta Disability System Breakdown
To: ALSS Minister; GOA ADAP Engagement; St. Albert constituency office
Sent: Monday, August 17, 2026, 1:04 PM

Dear Minister Neudorf,

I write on behalf of The Alberta Disability System Breakdown to request written clarification on the treatment of third-party payment and financial administrator arrangements during the transition from AISH to the Alberta Disability Assistance Program. We are placing this question in writing so that the answer forms part of the public record on the transition.

Section 12.7(1) of the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act, as amended by Bill 12 (SA 2025 c20 s.6), provides that a director may continue paying a third party all or part of a benefit where such payment was in place immediately before the provision came into force. Section 12.7(3) applies the same permissive language to financial administrators. Neither provision requires continuation. Section 6, as substituted, conditions third-party payment on the client's consent.

For a recipient whose rent reaches the landlord through one of these arrangements, the difference between a provision that permits continuation and one that requires it is the difference between housing that holds and housing that does not. We have received accounts from recipients who report that a direct rent payment stopped after their file moved to ADAP. We are not publishing those accounts as findings. We are asking the department to state the operating position.

We request written answers to the following:

1. Were existing third-party payment arrangements carried forward automatically on transition under section 12.6, or did continuation require an action by the client, the third party, or the department?
2. The same question for financial administrator arrangements under section 12.7(3).
3. Did the consent requirement in section 6 require a client's consent to be re-executed for arrangements predating the amended Act, and what became of arrangements where it had not been re-executed before the first ADAP payment period?
4. Where an arrangement did not continue, what notice was issued, to whom, and on what date?
5. What is the process and expected processing time for a client to re-establish a direct payment arrangement?
6. Where is this published for clients and their support workers?
7. How many files had a third-party payment or financial administrator arrangement in place immediately before July 2, 2026, and in how many did that arrangement remain in effect for the first ADAP payment period?

We would appreciate a response within 15 business days. We will relay the department's answer to our members without alteration.

Respectfully,
Chantal Trepanier
The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

2. Automated acknowledgement

From: ALSS Minister
Sent: Monday, August 17, 2026, 1:04 PM — the same minute the letter was sent

Thank you for reaching out to the Ministry of Assisted Living and Social Services. Please be assured that your request has been received and will be reviewed.

Minister Neudorf sincerely appreciates your message and your interest in engaging with our office.

Given the volume of requests currently being received, the Minister's Office is reviewing meeting and event opportunities in alignment with ministry priorities and scheduling availability.

Should a meeting or event be feasible, a member of the Minister's team will follow up with you directly to coordinate next steps.

[The acknowledgement then lists crisis and support telephone numbers: the Income Support Contact Centre, the Family Violence Info Line, the Child Abuse Hotline, the Bullying Helpline, the Mental Health Help Line and the Alberta Supports Contact Centre.]

3. Response from the Minister

From: ALSS Minister

Sent: Friday, September 11, 2026, 2:48 PM — twenty-five days after the letter

Dear Chantal Trepanier:

Thank you for your email regarding the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program, the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP), third-party payments and the role of Financial Administrators. As Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services, I appreciate the opportunity to respond.

AISH and ADAP clients may be assisted in managing their benefits through an informal trustee, referred to as a Financial Administrator, who is appointed under the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act and AISH Regulations. Clients may need assistance managing their financial benefits when they lack the capacity to meet their basic needs and/or have an established a pattern of using their benefits in a way that puts their health at risk. AISH legislation requires a client's consent to the Financial Administrator appointment, except in cases where a medical professional has determined the client lacks the capacity to make financial decisions. In situations where the client does not have mental or physical capacity or will not consent to the Financial Administrator appointment, AISH or ADAP may appoint a Financial Administrator without consent. Financial Administrator appointments that were in place prior to July 2026 remained in effect for all AISH and ADAP, clients including those who transitioned between the programs.

Regarding third-party rent payments, a temporary system issue resulted in some payments being deposited directly to client bank accounts rather than issued to landlords. Clients were notified of this issue and advised to forward payments to landlords directly. The issue is now resolved, and future third-party payments will continue to be issued directly to the appropriate recipients.

Please be assured that disability income assistance will continue to be available for Albertans who rely on it to meet their needs. Alberta has the highest provincial disability benefit rates and most robust disability programs in Canada, and we continue to expand and improve these supports. Through Budget 2026, Alberta's government is investing a historic \$3.7 billion to support Albertans with disabilities this year alone, a year-over-year increase of almost \$100 million. Since 2019, this represents more than \$1 billion in additional investment, which is an increase of nearly 40 per cent.

Thank you again for writing.

Sincerely,

Honourable Nathan Neudorf

Minister of Assisted Living and Social Services

Where that leaves the seven questions

Question 2, on Financial Administrator arrangements, is answered. Appointments in place before July 2026 remained in effect across the transition.

Questions 1, 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7 are not addressed.

The response also volunteers something that was not asked: confirmation that a system issue caused third-party rent payments to be deposited to client accounts rather than issued to landlords, that clients were notified, and that the issue is resolved. Each of those three statements is worth holding on to.

A follow-up has been sent.

THE ALBERTA DISABILITY SYSTEM BREAKDOWN

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